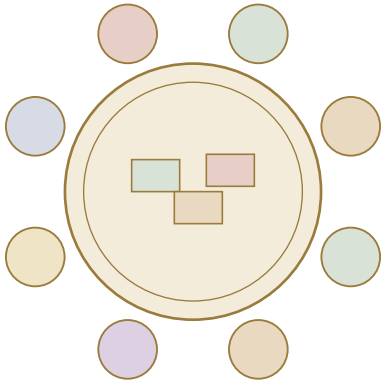


The Book Club Kit

Plan the year, choose the book, start the conversation.

PLANNER · VOTING · 126 QUESTION CARDS · BINGO · INVITATIONS · YEAR IN REVIEW

The Books Wanderer

How to use this kit

Print what you need, as many times as you need it.

1 Start with the charter

Fill in the club page and the roster once. It takes ten minutes and saves a year of questions.

2 Plan the year

The planner shows twelve gatherings on one page: book, host, date and what is on the table.

3 Choose the book together

Everyone nominates, everyone ranks three. The tally sheet picks the winner without an argument.

4 Run the evening

The agenda fits ninety minutes. The host checklist covers before, during and after.

5 Pick your cards

Cut out five or six question cards for the night. The deck has questions for any book, and a deck each for romance and fantasy, mystery, classics and nonfiction.

6 Warm up and play

Icebreaker cards for the first ten minutes, and four bingo cards for the moments every club knows.

7 Write it down

A notes page for each gathering and a scoring sheet for the verdict.

8 Look back

At the end of the year, the review pages turn twelve books into a favourite.

Prints well on plain paper. Also works in GoodNotes, Notability or any PDF app on a tablet.

Our book club

One page to say who we are and how we work.

CLUB NAME

STARTED

WE MEET

WHERE

MEMBERS (UP TO)

HOW WE CHOOSE THE BOOK

- ☐ We vote (nominate, then rank three)
- ☐ The host chooses, in turn
- ☐ A theme each month, then a vote
- ☐ We take turns by genre
- ☐ Anyone can suggest, the group decides

OUR RULES (KEEP THEM SHORT)

WHAT WE PROMISE EACH OTHER

- ☐ Be kind about the book, even when we disagree
- ☐ Say when we did not finish, without guilt
- ☐ Keep spoilers out of the invitation
- ☐ Let everyone speak before anyone speaks twice

OUR FIRST MEETING IS ON

The members

Names, how to reach them, and the snack they are known for.

	NAME	CONTACT	FAVOURITE KIND OF BOOK	BIRTHDAY MONTH
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				
13				
14				

The year at a glance

Twelve gatherings, one page.

Month	Book and author	Host	Date	On the table
January				
February				
March				
April				
May				
June				
July				
August				
September				
October				
November				
December				

Nominations

Each member proposes up to two books. Say why in one line.

	TITLE	AUTHOR	PAGES	KIND OF BOOK	NOMINATED BY
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10					
11					
12					

WHY THIS ONE, IN A SENTENCE (FOR THE BOOKS THE GROUP MIGHT NOT KNOW)

The ballot

Rank your top three. First choice 3 points, second 2, third 1. Cut along the dotted lines.

Our next book

NAME _____

		1st	2nd	3rd
☐	_____	○	○	○
☐	_____	○	○	○
☐	_____	○	○	○
☐	_____	○	○	○
☐	_____	○	○	○

Our next book

NAME _____

		1st	2nd	3rd
☐	_____	○	○	○
☐	_____	○	○	○
☐	_____	○	○	○
☐	_____	○	○	○
☐	_____	○	○	○

Our next book

NAME _____

		1st	2nd	3rd
☐	_____	○	○	○
☐	_____	○	○	○
☐	_____	○	○	○
☐	_____	○	○	○
☐	_____	○	○	○

The tally

Write each ballot's points in a column. The highest total is the next book.

BOOK	#1	#2	#3	#4	#5	#6	#7	#8	#9	#10	TOTAL

If two books tie, the host picks the one the group has waited longest to read.

THE WINNER IS _____

An evening in ninety minutes

A shape to follow, and to bend.

0:00 — Arrive and settle

Drinks, seats, phones away. No book talk yet.

0:10 — One sentence each

Everyone says how the book left them, in one sentence. No replies yet.

0:20 — Warm-up card

Draw one icebreaker card and go round the room.

0:30 — The big questions

Draw three question cards. Let the answers wander.

0:55 — The hard question

The one that divides the room. Ask for the other side before the first one repeats.

1:10 — Verdict and quotes

Stars on the scoring sheet. Each member shares a line worth keeping.

1:20 — Choose the next book

Nominations, ballots, tally. Or announce the host's pick.

1:25 — Close

Date, place, who hosts. Thank the host. Write the notes.

The host's checklist

Before, during and after. Nothing to remember on the day.

Two weeks before

- ☐ Confirm the date, the time and the place
- ☐ Send the invitation, with the book and the date
- ☐ Check who has the book, and who needs a loan

The week before

- ☐ Send a short reminder
- ☐ Choose five question cards and one icebreaker
- ☐ Decide on the drinks and the table
- ☐ Prepare a place to put the notes

On the day

- ☐ Seats in a circle, with room for everyone to see everyone
- ☐ Cards, pens, the scoring sheet
- ☐ Let the first person speak before you do
- ☐ Keep time lightly, and keep the next date for last

Afterwards

- ☐ Write the notes page while it is fresh
- ☐ Send the next date and the next book
- ☐ Thank the group, and anyone who brought something

NOTES FOR THIS GATHERING

Questions for any book

Cut along the dotted lines. Page 1 of 3.

ANY BOOK · 01 ☆☆☆

What was the very first thing you thought when you finished the last page?

ANY BOOK · 02 ☆☆☆

Which sentence would you underline, and what does it do for the book?

ANY BOOK · 03 ☆☆☆

Where did you slow down, and where did you skim?

ANY BOOK · 04 ☆☆☆

Which character did you trust least at the start? Did that change?

ANY BOOK · 05 ☆☆☆

If this book were a place, what would it be like to live there?

ANY BOOK · 06 ☆☆☆

What did the author leave out that you wish had been in?

ANY BOOK · 07 ☆☆☆

Which scene would you keep if you could keep only one?

ANY BOOK · 08 ☆☆☆

Did the title mean something different by the end?

ANY BOOK · 09 ☆☆☆

Who is the book really about, and is it the person on the cover?

ANY BOOK · 10 ☆☆☆

What do you think happens the day after the last page?

ANY BOOK · 11 ☆☆☆

Which chapter could be cut without anyone noticing, and which one is the heart?

ANY BOOK · 12 ☆☆☆

Name a moment where you disagreed with a character out loud, or wanted to.

ANY BOOK · 13 ☆☆☆

What does this book believe about people? Do you agree?

ANY BOOK · 14 ☆☆☆

If you could ask the author one question, what would it be?

ANY BOOK · 15 ☆☆☆

How did the way the story is told (voice, order, point of view) change how you felt?

ANY BOOK · 16 ☆☆☆

Which minor character deserves their own book?

ANY BOOK · 17 ☆☆☆

What does the setting do that another place could not?

ANY BOOK · 18 ☆☆☆

Was there a moment you put the book down on purpose? Why?

Questions for any book

Cut along the dotted lines. Page 2 of 3.

ANY BOOK · 19 ☆☆☆

Which part felt most true to your own life?

ANY BOOK · 20 ☆☆☆

What would you say to someone who disliked this book?

ANY BOOK · 21 ☆☆☆

What would you say to someone who loved it?

ANY BOOK · 22 ☆☆☆

Which line of dialogue sounds like something a real person would say?

ANY BOOK · 23 ☆☆☆

What is the book afraid of?

ANY BOOK · 24 ☆☆☆

What did you know too early, or find out too late?

ANY BOOK · 25 ☆☆☆

Did the ending feel earned, rushed, or too tidy?

ANY BOOK · 26 ☆☆☆

Which decision in the book would you have made differently?

ANY BOOK · 27 ☆☆☆

What is the smallest detail you keep thinking about?

ANY BOOK · 28 ☆☆☆

Who would you give this book to, and who would you keep it from?

ANY BOOK · 29 ☆☆☆

How would a different decade have changed this story?

ANY BOOK · 30 ☆☆☆

What did the first page promise, and did the book keep that promise?

ANY BOOK · 31 ☆☆☆

Which feeling did the book make you feel most, and on which page?

ANY BOOK · 32 ☆☆☆

Is there a character you disliked and yet understood?

ANY BOOK · 33 ☆☆☆

What did you learn from this book that you did not expect to learn?

ANY BOOK · 34 ☆☆☆

How would you describe the book in three words?

ANY BOOK · 35 ☆☆☆

Which two characters should never have met? Which two should have met sooner?

ANY BOOK · 36 ☆☆☆

What is the book's biggest risk, and did it pay off?

Questions for any book

Cut along the dotted lines. Page 3 of 3.

ANY BOOK · 37 ☆☆☆

Which object matters most in the story, and why?

ANY BOOK · 38 ☆☆☆

What does the weather, the season or the time of day do in this book?

ANY BOOK · 39 ☆☆☆

If you were casting the characters as friends, who would you invite to dinner?

ANY BOOK · 40 ☆☆☆

What is the most surprising thing about how you felt while reading it?

ANY BOOK · 41 ☆☆☆

What would you cut from the cover blurb? What would you add?

ANY BOOK · 42 ☆☆☆

Which chapter would you read aloud to the group?

ANY BOOK · 43 ☆☆☆

How did this book change over the weeks, or the days, you spent reading it?

ANY BOOK · 44 ☆☆☆

What is the question the book keeps asking without saying it?

ANY BOOK · 45 ☆☆☆

Which character changes the most, and what changes them?

ANY BOOK · 46 ☆☆☆

What would you have wanted the author to do with the last chapter?

ANY BOOK · 47 ☆☆☆

Where did the book surprise you by being funny, tender or harder than expected?

ANY BOOK · 48 ☆☆☆

What do you want to remember from this book in a year?

ANY BOOK · 49 ☆☆☆

If this book had a soundtrack, what would the first song be?

ANY BOOK · 50 ☆☆☆

Which question about this book did nobody ask yet?

ANY BOOK · 51 ☆☆☆

Does the book change how you will read the next one?

ANY BOOK · 52 ☆☆☆

What is the most quotable thing in it, and what makes it quotable?

ANY BOOK · 53 ☆☆☆

If the club could change one thing about the book, what would it be?

ANY BOOK · 54 ☆☆☆

Would you read it again? When, and for what reason?

Romance and romantasy

Questions for this kind of book. Cut along the dotted lines.

ROMANCE · 01 ☆☆☆

What keeps the two main characters apart, and is the reason strong enough?

ROMANCE · 02 ☆☆☆

Which moment made you believe they belong together?

ROMANCE · 03 ☆☆☆

How does the book handle trust: given, earned or broken?

ROMANCE · 04 ☆☆☆

Which trope did the book use, and did it make it feel new?

ROMANCE · 05 ☆☆☆

Who has more to lose, and how does the author show it?

ROMANCE · 06 ☆☆☆

What does each character want apart from the other one?

ROMANCE · 07 ☆☆☆

Was the pacing of the relationship satisfying, rushed or slow?

ROMANCE · 08 ☆☆☆

Which supporting friendship or family tie carried the book for you?

ROMANCE · 09 ☆☆☆

If the story has a magic system or a made-up world, what are its rules and its costs?

ROMANCE · 10 ☆☆☆

How do the world's rules shape the love story?

ROMANCE · 11 ☆☆☆

Which scene was a quiet moment that mattered more than a big one?

ROMANCE · 12 ☆☆☆

Do the characters talk to each other honestly? When do they stop?

ROMANCE · 13 ☆☆☆

What does the book say about being chosen, and about choosing?

ROMANCE · 14 ☆☆☆

How did the setting help the romance, or get in its way?

ROMANCE · 15 ☆☆☆

Which line would you save to send to someone?

ROMANCE · 16 ☆☆☆

Did you want the ending the book gave you, or a different one?

ROMANCE · 17 ☆☆☆

What would you ask one of the characters for advice about?

ROMANCE · 18 ☆☆☆

What would a sequel have to do to keep the spell?

Mystery and thriller

Questions for this kind of book. Cut along the dotted lines.

MYSTERY · 01 ☆☆☆

When did you first suspect the answer, and what tipped you off?

MYSTERY · 02 ☆☆☆

Which clue looks different now that you know the ending?

MYSTERY · 03 ☆☆☆

Which red herring fooled you the longest?

MYSTERY · 04 ☆☆☆

Is the narrator honest with the reader? Where do you check?

MYSTERY · 05 ☆☆☆

How does the author build tension: with action, with information, or with silence?

MYSTERY · 06 ☆☆☆

Which character had the most believable reason, even if they were not guilty?

MYSTERY · 07 ☆☆☆

Is the solution fair to the reader? Could you have solved it?

MYSTERY · 08 ☆☆☆

What does the detective, or the main character, get wrong?

MYSTERY · 09 ☆☆☆

What does the book think justice is, and do you agree?

MYSTERY · 10 ☆☆☆

Which scene scared you, and what made it work?

MYSTERY · 11 ☆☆☆

Where did the setting add to the mystery?

MYSTERY · 12 ☆☆☆

Did the final reveal feel earned, or did it come from nowhere?

MYSTERY · 13 ☆☆☆

Who suffers most from what happened, and does the book notice?

MYSTERY · 14 ☆☆☆

Which question stays open after the last page?

MYSTERY · 15 ☆☆☆

How would the story change if told by the culprit?

MYSTERY · 16 ☆☆☆

What detail would you only notice on a second reading?

MYSTERY · 17 ☆☆☆

Is the ending satisfying even if the case is solved?

MYSTERY · 18 ☆☆☆

What would you change about the plot to make it harder to guess?

Classics

Questions for this kind of book. Cut along the dotted lines.

CLASSICS · 01 ☆☆☆
Why do you think this book has lasted, and is it enough?

CLASSICS · 02 ☆☆☆
What in it feels modern, and what feels foreign?

CLASSICS · 03 ☆☆☆
Which sentence made you stop because of how it was written?

CLASSICS · 04 ☆☆☆
How did the language slow you down, and what did you gain from that?

CLASSICS · 05 ☆☆☆
Which character would be easiest to meet today, and which would be hardest?

CLASSICS · 06 ☆☆☆
What assumptions of the time does the book carry? How does it handle them?

CLASSICS · 07 ☆☆☆
What did the book get right about people that has not changed?

CLASSICS · 08 ☆☆☆
Which part would you change if you were editing it today, and which would you leave alone?

CLASSICS · 09 ☆☆☆
How does the book compare with what you expected before you opened it?

CLASSICS · 10 ☆☆☆
Who is the book unfair to, and does it notice?

CLASSICS · 11 ☆☆☆
Which scene do you think everyone remembers, and is it the right one?

CLASSICS · 12 ☆☆☆
If it were published today, would it find readers?

CLASSICS · 13 ☆☆☆
What does the ending tell us about what the author believed?

CLASSICS · 14 ☆☆☆
How do money, class or family shape the plot?

CLASSICS · 15 ☆☆☆
What would you like to know about the time it was written?

CLASSICS · 16 ☆☆☆
Which edition did you read, and did the introduction or notes help?

CLASSICS · 17 ☆☆☆
Who should read it first, and who should wait?

CLASSICS · 18 ☆☆☆
What would you add to the shelf next to it?

Nonfiction and memoir

Questions for this kind of book. Cut along the dotted lines.

NONFICTION · 01 ☆☆☆
What is the author's central claim, in your own words?

NONFICTION · 02 ☆☆☆
Which part persuaded you most? Which part did not?

NONFICTION · 03 ☆☆☆
What evidence did the author use, and was it enough?

NONFICTION · 04 ☆☆☆
How does the author's own life or voice shape the argument?

NONFICTION · 05 ☆☆☆
Which fact or story do you want to tell someone tonight?

NONFICTION · 06 ☆☆☆
What did you already believe that the book challenged?

NONFICTION · 07 ☆☆☆
What does the author leave out, on purpose or by accident?

NONFICTION · 08 ☆☆☆
Whose voice is missing from this book?

NONFICTION · 09 ☆☆☆
Would the book work as well if it were half as long?

NONFICTION · 10 ☆☆☆
Which chapter changed how you saw something ordinary?

NONFICTION · 11 ☆☆☆
How honest does the author seem to be about their own mistakes?

NONFICTION · 12 ☆☆☆
What would you ask the people in the book?

NONFICTION · 13 ☆☆☆
Which idea would you try in your own life, and which would you not?

NONFICTION · 14 ☆☆☆
How does the structure (chronological, thematic, essays) help or hurt?

NONFICTION · 15 ☆☆☆
What does the book say about memory, and how much do you trust it?

NONFICTION · 16 ☆☆☆
What is the most useful sentence in the book?

NONFICTION · 17 ☆☆☆
Who should read it, and what should they do afterwards?

NONFICTION · 18 ☆☆☆
What do you still want to know?

Our verdict

Stars and a few words from every member. Copy it for each gathering.

THE BOOK _____ **DATE** _____

NAME	STARS	IN A FEW WORDS
	☆☆☆☆☆	
	☆☆☆☆☆	
	☆☆☆☆☆	
	☆☆☆☆☆	
	☆☆☆☆☆	
	☆☆☆☆☆	
	☆☆☆☆☆	
	☆☆☆☆☆	
	☆☆☆☆☆	
	☆☆☆☆☆	
	☆☆☆☆☆	
	☆☆☆☆☆	

THE AVERAGE, AND THE LINE WE WILL REMEMBER

Book club bingo A

Mark a square when it happens. A line wins a round of tea; a full card wins the next pick.

Tea or wine is refilled	Someone defends a character nobody likes	Someone reads a passage aloud	The book is lent to someone	A character is called annoying
Everyone agrees (shocking)	Someone compares it to another book	Someone arrives late	Someone did not finish the book	Someone is quoted back to themselves
A new book is added to the list	A chair is moved closer	The book *was discussed*	Someone says "I cried"	Snacks match the book
A small spoiler slips out	Someone says "I did not expect that"	Someone asks "Did anyone else get confused?"	Someone read ahead and kept quiet	The date is moved
A tangent about a TV series	A page number is called out	The ending divides the room	Someone gives it five stars	The host's pet joins in

FIRST LINE WON BY _____

FULL CARD WON BY _____

THE BOOK WE PLAYED DURING _____

Book club bingo B

Mark a square when it happens. A line wins a round of tea; a full card wins the next pick.

Laughter at the wrong moment	A new book is added to the list	A question stays open	Someone arrives late	A chair is moved closer
The next book is argued about	A phone rings	Someone defends a character nobody likes	A word is looked up	Everyone agrees (shocking)
The book is lent to someone	A page number is called out	The book *was discussed*	Someone gives it five stars	Someone did not finish the book
The ending divides the room	Someone says "I cried"	Someone reads a passage aloud	The date is moved	Someone changes their mind
A quote is photographed	A small spoiler slips out	Someone is quoted back to themselves	Someone says "I will reread it"	A character is called annoying

FIRST LINE WON BY _____

FULL CARD WON BY _____

THE BOOK WE PLAYED DURING _____

Book club bingo C

Mark a square when it happens. A line wins a round of tea; a full card wins the next pick.

A word is looked up	A phone rings	The host's pet joins in	Someone is quoted back to themselves	Someone read ahead and kept quiet
A character is called annoying	Someone compares it to another book	Someone changes their mind	A page number is called out	Everyone agrees (shocking)
The book is lent to someone	Someone defends a character nobody likes	The book *was discussed*	Someone asks "Did anyone else get confused?"	Someone did not finish the book
Someone says "I did not expect that"	Tea or wine is refilled	Someone arrives late	Someone reads a passage aloud	Someone wants a sequel
A tangent about a TV series	A question stays open	The ending divides the room	A new book is added to the list	Someone gives it two stars

FIRST LINE WON BY _____

FULL CARD WON BY _____

THE BOOK WE PLAYED DURING _____

Book club bingo D

Mark a square when it happens. A line wins a round of tea; a full card wins the next pick.

Tea or wine is refilled	A chair is moved closer	Someone reads a passage aloud	Everyone agrees (shocking)	Someone says "I cried"
Someone asks "Did anyone else get confused?"	The date is moved	Someone gives it two stars	Someone compares it to another book	Someone gives it five stars
A tangent about a TV series	Talk about the cover	The book *was discussed*	A page number is called out	Someone says "I did not expect that"
Someone read ahead and kept quiet	A question stays open	A small spoiler slips out	A quote is photographed	Someone wants a sequel
A phone rings	A word is looked up	The next book is argued about	Someone changes their mind	Someone says "I will reread it"

FIRST LINE WON BY _____

FULL CARD WON BY _____

THE BOOK WE PLAYED DURING _____

Icebreakers

Twelve cards for the first ten minutes. Cut along the dotted lines.

ICEBREAKER · 01 ☆☆☆

Which book have you pretended to have read?

ICEBREAKER · 02 ☆☆☆

Which fictional town would you move to tomorrow?

ICEBREAKER · 03 ☆☆☆

What is the best last line you remember?

ICEBREAKER · 04 ☆☆☆

Name a book you read in one sitting.

ICEBREAKER · 05 ☆☆☆

Which cover made you buy a book?

ICEBREAKER · 06 ☆☆☆

What is the longest you have taken to finish a book?

ICEBREAKER · 07 ☆☆☆

Which character would you want as a neighbour?

ICEBREAKER · 08 ☆☆☆

What is your reading spot, and what do you need there?

ICEBREAKER · 09 ☆☆☆

Which book do you lend, and which do you never lend?

ICEBREAKER · 10 ☆☆☆

What did you read as a child that you would still read now?

ICEBREAKER · 11 ☆☆☆

Which genre do you avoid, and which one surprised you once?

ICEBREAKER · 12 ☆☆☆

What is the book you most want everyone to have read?

Invitations

Cut, fill in and send. Photograph it for the group chat if you prefer.

You are invited

to talk about a book over something good to drink

THE BOOK _____

DATE AND TIME _____

WHERE _____

HOST _____

BRING (OPTIONAL) _____

You are invited

to talk about a book over something good to drink

THE BOOK _____

DATE AND TIME _____

WHERE _____

HOST _____

BRING (OPTIONAL) _____

You are invited

to talk about a book over something good to drink

THE BOOK _____

DATE AND TIME _____

WHERE _____

HOST _____

BRING (OPTIONAL) _____

You are invited

to talk about a book over something good to drink

THE BOOK _____

DATE AND TIME _____

WHERE _____

HOST _____

BRING (OPTIONAL) _____

You are invited

to talk about a book over something good to drink

THE BOOK _____

DATE AND TIME _____

WHERE _____

HOST _____

BRING (OPTIONAL) _____

You are invited

to talk about a book over something good to drink

THE BOOK _____

DATE AND TIME _____

WHERE _____

HOST _____

BRING (OPTIONAL) _____

Gathering notes 1

What we said, what we decided, what we will remember.

THE BOOK _____ **DATE** _____

WHO CAME

WHAT WE SAID

A LINE WORTH KEEPING, AND WHO FOUND IT

WHAT WE COULD NOT AGREE ON

NEXT TIME

Gathering notes 2

What we said, what we decided, what we will remember.

THE BOOK _____ **DATE** _____

WHO CAME

WHAT WE SAID

A LINE WORTH KEEPING, AND WHO FOUND IT

WHAT WE COULD NOT AGREE ON

NEXT TIME

Gathering notes 3

What we said, what we decided, what we will remember.

THE BOOK **DATE**

WHO CAME

WHAT WE SAID

A LINE WORTH KEEPING, AND WHO FOUND IT

WHAT WE COULD NOT AGREE ON

NEXT TIME

The year in review

Twelve books, in numbers.

BOOKS WE READ	**MEETINGS HELD**	**MEMBERS WHO CAME**
BOOKS WE LOVED	**BOOKS WE ARGUED ABOUT**	**BOOKS NOBODY FINISHED**
LONGEST BOOK	**SHORTEST BOOK**	**BEST SNACK**

THE THREE THAT STAYED WITH US

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

THE BOOK WE WOULD HAND TO ANOTHER CLUB, AND WHY

Awards and next year

Because every club deserves a ceremony.

BEST DISCUSSION

FUNNIEST MOMENT

BIGGEST SURPRISE

BEST HOST

BEST ENDING WE READ

WHAT WE WANT MORE OF NEXT YEAR

WHAT WE WOULD CHANGE

THE BOOKS WE WANT TO READ TOGETHER

Good books are better with company

Thank you for using the kit. Print it again whenever the club does.

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